

CITATION QUICK GUIDE

Pick one format and use it for every source. Copy the pattern, then swap in your own details.

MLA, 9TH EDITION

Website

Author Last, First. "Title of Page." Website Name, Publisher, Date, URL.

Book

Author Last, First. Title of Book. Publisher, Year.

Journal article

Author Last, First. "Article Title." Journal Name, vol. #, no. #, Year, pages.

In-text

(Author page number)

Works Cited page. Alphabetize by author last name.

APA, 7TH EDITION

Website

Author Last, F. (Year, Month Day). Title of page. Website Name. URL

Book

Author Last, F. (Year). Title of book. Publisher.

Journal article

Author Last, F. (Year). Article title. Journal Name, Volume(Issue), pages.

In-text

(Author, Year)

References page. Alphabetize by author last name.

NO AUTHOR LISTED?

Start with the title in MLA. In APA, use the organization as the author. If there is no date, use n.d. in APA and omit the date in MLA.

WHAT ALWAYS NEEDS A CITATION

- Any fact, number, or statistic you did not measure yourself
- Any idea or explanation you learned from someone else, even in your own words
- Any direct quote, which also needs quotation marks
- Any image, chart, or diagram you did not make

ASK WHICH FORMAT YOUR SCHOOL WANTS

Most middle schools use MLA and most science competitions accept either. Pick one and use it consistently through the whole paper. Mixing formats costs points.